

ACCOUNT HOLDER
You, the homeowner.
Required by covenant to maintain lawn.

PREVIOUS BALANCE
Last summer's lawn water.

CURRENT CHARGES
50% of this bill is your lawn.
Half of that evaporated.

AMOUNT DUE
\$200+
per summer month
(for a lawn you probably hate)



EVERY HOME HAS A SEWER RATE ON IT, TOO.

YOUR WATER BILL IS A LAWN BILL.

- ☐ Water bills up 24% in 5 years — faster than inflation
- ☐ Up to 70% of summer water use goes to lawn irrigation
- ☐ Half of that water evaporates before reaching roots
- ☐ Your city mandates the lawn. You pay the bill.
- ☐ A water efficiency tip from your utility
- ☐ Any help canceling your HOA lawn requirement

NOTICE: This bill will increase next year.
And the year after that.

ISSUE NO.	SUBJECT	BENEFICIARY	YOUR BENEFIT
02	Lawn water	Your lawn	None

THE BILL EXPLAINED.

Open your summer water bill. Look at the total. Now understand what you're actually paying for.

ITEM	% OF SUMMER BILL
Lawn irrigation	50-70%
Household water (showers, dishes, laundry)	30-50%
Water that reaches roots	~25-35%
Water that evaporates	~25-35%
Sewer charge on lawn water	Included

Water and sewer bills rose 24% in five years — faster than inflation, faster than groceries, faster than gas. In some cities, minimum-wage earners work 20 hours a month just to cover it.

"My bill just came in. I knew it was going to be astronomical. \$765.44 for the quarter — about \$255 a month. That's \$56.70 per month per thousand square feet of lawn."
— aroundtheyard.com forums, homeowner in New Jersey

The sewer charge is the hidden knife. Most utilities bill sewer fees based on total water consumption — including water that soaks into your lawn and never enters a drain. You pay to treat water that evaporated into the sky.

"Mine is \$175-\$200 during the growing season. It wouldn't be more than \$75 but the sewer formula uses total gallons — so I'm paying sewer prices on irrigation water."
— thelawnforum.com, homeowner on mandatory HOA irrigation

This is not a leak. It is the system working as designed.

THE MANDATE. YOU DIDN'T CHOOSE THIS.

Your water bill is high because your lawn requires water. Your lawn exists because the law requires it — or the HOA covenant, or the zoning code, or the social sanction waiting for you the moment you let it go brown.

You did not freely choose a lawn. You inherited an enforcement system that made lawn maintenance the default and made deviation expensive. The water bill is how that enforcement costs you money every month.



THIS IS YOUR SUMMER SATURDAYS. AND YOUR WATER BILL.

WHAT YOU'RE PAYING FOR.

□ THE LAWN ITSELF

A monoculture that produces nothing, supports almost no wildlife, and increases urban flooding by compacting soil.

□ THE ENFORCEMENT

Weed ordinances, HOA fines, social pressure. The system that makes it illegal not to water the thing that's draining your bill.

□ THE CHEMICAL INDUSTRY

Fertilizers and pesticides that make the grass grow so you need to water it more, mow it more, and buy more fertilizer.

□ THE APPEARANCE OF CONFORMITY

That is the only thing lawns produce. You are paying \$200 a month for your neighbors not to complain.

"We eliminated our lawn. Summer water usage is literally 10–15% of what it was. The combined rebates paid for half the cost to change."

— Bogleheads.org forum, California homeowner

STOP PAYING FOR YOUR LAWN. START HERE.



Water that grows something. Radical concept.

Water bills will keep rising. The lawn mandate will keep costing you. The only exit is changing the law.

REDUCE YOUR BILL NOW

Stop watering. Seriously. Most lawns go dormant, not dead. They recover. Your HOA may send a notice. That notice is the argument.

CUT IT BY 85%

Replace lawn with native plants. California and other states offer rebates that cover up to half the cost. Check yours.

ELIMINATE IT ENTIRELY

Advocate for ordinance reform. Every city that has relaxed weed ordinances has seen mass voluntary conversion. People don't love their lawns. They comply with them.

JOIN US.

- Read the manifesto: jason-edelman.org/abolish-lawns
- Follow @abolish.lawns on Instagram
- Stop watering. Document it. Share it.
- Show up to your utility commission meeting.
- Print this. Leave it on a neighbor's doorstep.

PRINT THIS. SHARE IT. PROPAGATE FREELY.

jason-edelman.org/abolish-lawns

commons framework: power-explained.jason-edelman.org